Braiden J. Miller

Senior Software Engineer | Backend & Distributed Systems

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SUMMARY

Senior software engineer building Java and Kotlin backend systems since 2019. Delivers API-first services, event-driven workflows and secure integrations, with hands-on ownership from architecture through production. Combines technical leadership with 7+ years of prior multi-unit retail management, balancing business needs, delivery risk and technical debt.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer II

Pax8 | 2022 - Present

- Extracted a domain from a monolith and migrated millions of records while keeping both systems synchronized; verified parity and retained a tested rollback path through cutover.
- Replaced a search path taking more than 60 seconds with Elasticsearch in one two-week sprint, achieving sub-second results and enabling a relaunch.
- Designed an idempotent webhook platform using Kafka, DDD and CQRS. Load testing dispatched 10,000 outbound calls in under 30 seconds; backpressure protected downstream services.
- Implemented Auth0 authentication and fine-grained authorization (FGA) for multi-tenant services.
- Secured sensitive data with tenant-level KMS encryption. Diagnosed redundant encryption work and reduced daily KMS calls from more than 10,000 to fewer than 100.
- Built search capabilities using Lucene-syntax queries and semantic search.
- Established API-first standards, documented public APIs, shared libraries and boundary-focused testing patterns.
- Applied Axon-based DDD/CQRS and ports and adapters. Used modular monoliths where domain boundaries were unclear, weighing service extraction against business needs and operational complexity.
- Owned production behavior through distributed traces, metrics, SLOs and alerting; improved diagnosis and resolution of customer-reported defects.
- Led technical planning and coached engineers across product and dependent teams, making architecture tradeoffs, delivery dependencies and technical debt explicit.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE CONTINUED

Software Engineer

Zen Planner / Daxko | 2020 - 2022

- Built greenfield microservices with CI/CD, contract tests and unit, integration and end-to-end coverage.
- Implemented Stripe-backed billing for proration, split funding, multiple locations, partial payments, refunds and varied subscription schedules.
- Integrated Kafka, webhooks, API gateways and documented public APIs across team and vendor boundaries.

Software Developer II

NexGen Technologies | 2019 - 2020

- Developed and optimized Java/Spring services in a large production application through design reviews and pair programming.
- Reduced monolith coupling by extracting reusable components and adding tests and APIs for incremental delivery.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Backend: Java, Kotlin, Spring Boot, Axon Framework, REST, OpenAPI, DDD, CQRS, ports and adapters

Data and messaging: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, MySQL, Elasticsearch/OpenSearch, Kafka, Lucene, semantic search

Identity and security: Auth0, fine-grained authorization, tenant-level KMS encryption

Cloud and delivery: AWS, Terraform, Docker, Kubernetes, GitHub Actions, CI/CD

Quality and operations: Distributed tracing, metrics, SLOs, alerting, Honeycomb, contract/integration/load testing

Frontend: React, TypeScript, Angular (AngularJS 1.x and Angular 2+)

PERSONAL ENGINEERING PROJECT

Platform App Lab / Media Transfer

Build and operate a self-hosted Kotlin/Spring Boot modular platform with a React client, Axon-backed domain lifecycles and selected provider ports/adapters. Publish release-matched OpenAPI, ADRs and diagrams alongside automated tests, deployment and operational tooling.

Architecture and APIs | Source code

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

B.S., Business Management | Western Governors University | 2017

Full Stack Java Program | Skill Distillery | 2019

Oracle Certified Associate, Java SE 8 Programmer I | CompTIA Project+